

Annual Leave Policy (Republic of Ireland)

Jurisdiction: Ireland | Effective date: 1 January 2026 | Version 2.0 | Owner: HR Advisory Team

1. Statutory Entitlement

Under the Organisation of Working Time Act 1997, employees are entitled to 4 working weeks of paid annual leave per leave year. Entitlement is calculated by whichever of the following gives the greater result: (a) 4 working weeks where the employee works at least 1,365 hours in the leave year; (b) one third of a working week per calendar month of at least 117 hours worked; or (c) 8% of hours worked, subject to a maximum of 4 working weeks.

2. Public Holidays

Ireland has 10 public holidays. Public holidays are separate from, and additional to, the annual leave entitlement. An employee required to work on a public holiday is entitled to an additional day's pay, a paid day off within a month, or an additional day of annual leave.

3. Carry-Over and Payment in Lieu

Annual leave should normally be taken within the leave year. With the employee's consent, leave may be taken within 6 months of the following year. Payment in lieu of untaken statutory leave is only permitted on termination of employment.

4. Notice Requirements for Booking Leave

Employees in Ireland must submit leave requests at least 4 weeks in advance for requests longer than 3 days, and at least 1 week in advance for shorter requests. The employer must take family responsibilities and available rest into account when approving leave.